

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

----- X

CADEEM CLARKE,

Plaintiff,

-against-

SUMMONS

DETECTIVE JOHN LINDSEY, Shield No. 4343,
UNDERCOVER POLICE OFFICER, Shield No. 352,
POLICE OFFICER LUIS MALDONADO, Shield No.
00836, and SERGEANT CECILIA LUCKIE,

Index No.:

The Basis of Venue is:
Location of Incident

Defendants.

Plaintiff designates BRONX
County as the place of trial.

----- X

To the above named Defendants:

You are hereby summoned to answer the Verified Complaint in this action, and to serve a copy of your Verified Answer to the Verified Complaint, or, if the Verified Complaint is not served with this Summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorneys within twenty days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by delivery upon you personally within the state, or, within 30 days after completion of service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

DATED: New York, New York
December 28, 2020

Yours, etc.

/s/

JACOBS & HAZAN, LLP.
STUART E. JACOBS, ESQ.
Attorney for Plaintiff
30 Vesey Street, 4th Floor
New York, New York 10007
(212) 577-2690

TO: DETECTIVE JOHN LINDSEY, Shield No. 4343, Narcotics Borough Bronx, One Police Plaza, Room 110-c, New York, NY 10038
UNDERCOVER POLICE OFFICER, Shield No. 352, Narcotics Borough Bronx, One Police Plaza, Room 110-c, New York, NY 10038
POLICE OFFICER LUIS MALDONADO, Shield No. 00836, Narcotics Borough Bronx, One Police Plaza, Room 110-c, New York, NY 10038
SERGEANT CECILIA LUCKIE, Narcotics Borough Bronx, One Police Plaza, Room 110-c, New York, NY 10038

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

----- X

CADEEM CLARKE,

Plaintiff,

INDEX NO.:

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

-against-

DETECTIVE JOHN LINDSEY, Shield No. 4343,
UNDERCOVER POLICE OFFICER, Shield No. 352,
POLICE OFFICER LUIS MALDONADO, Shield No.
00836, and SERGEANT CECILIA LUCKIE,

JURY TRIAL DEMANDED

Defendants.

----- X

Plaintiff, CADEEM CLARKE, by his attorneys, Jacobs & Hazan, LLP, as and for his Verified Complaint herein, alleges upon information and belief as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. This is a civil rights action to recover money damages arising out of defendants' violation of plaintiff's rights as secured by the Civil Rights Act, 42 U.S.C. Sections 1983 and 1988, and of rights secured by the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution. On April 7, 2018, at approximately 3:00 p.m., plaintiff Cadeem Clarke, while lawfully in the vicinity of White Plains Road and East 227th Street, Bronx, New York, was subject to an unlawful stop, question, frisk, search, false arrest, and false imprisonment by the defendant New York City police officers. Plaintiff was unlawfully imprisoned at the 48th Precinct. Plaintiff was maliciously prosecuted and denied the right to due process and a fair trial until all charges against plaintiff were dismissed on July 16, 2018. Plaintiff was deprived of his constitutional rights when the individual defendants unlawfully stopped, questioned, frisked, searched, confined, falsely arrested, falsely imprisoned, maliciously prosecuted and denied plaintiff the right to due process and a fair trial in violation of the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, the common law and the laws of the State of New York.

PARTIES

2. Plaintiff CADEEM CLARKE is a resident of the state of New York.

3. DETECTIVE JOHN LINDSEY, Shield No. 4343, is and was at all times relevant herein, an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.

4. DETECTIVE JOHN LINDSEY, Shield No. 4343, was at all times relevant herein, assigned to the Narcotics Borough Bronx.

5. DETECTIVE JOHN LINDSEY, Shield No. 4343, is being sued in his individual and official capacity.

6. UNDERCOVER POLICE OFFICER, Shield No. 352, is and was at all times relevant herein, an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.

7. UNDERCOVER POLICE OFFICER, Shield No. 352, was at all times relevant herein, assigned to the Narcotics Borough Bronx.

8. UNDERCOVER POLICE OFFICER, Shield No. 352, is being sued in his individual and official capacity.

9. POLICE OFFICER LUIS MALDONADO, Shield No. 00836 is and was at all times relevant herein, an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.

10. POLICE OFFICER LUIS MALDONADO, Shield No. 00836 was at all times relevant herein, assigned to the Narcotics Borough Bronx Squad.

11. POLICE OFFICER LUIS MALDONADO, Shield No. 00836 is being sued in his individual and official capacity.

12. SERGEANT CECILIA LUCKIE, is and was at all times relevant herein, an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.

13. SERGEANT CECILIA LUCKIE, was at all times relevant herein, assigned to the Narcotics Borough Bronx.

14. SERGEANT CECILIA LUCKIE, is being sued in his individual and official capacity.

15. At all times relevant herein, the individual defendants were acting under color of state law in the course and scope of their duties and functions as agents, servants, employees and officers of the New York City Police Department, and otherwise performed and engaged in conduct incidental to the performance of their lawful functions in the course of their duties. They were acting for and on behalf of the New York City Police Department at all times relevant herein, with the power and authority vested in them as officers, agents and employees of the New York City Police Department and incidental to the lawful pursuit of their duties as officers, employees and agents of the New York City Police Department.

16. Defendant City of New York is a municipal entity created and authorized under the laws of the State of New York. It is authorized by law to maintain a police

department, which acts as its agent in the area of law enforcement and for which it is ultimately responsible. The defendant City of New York assumes the risks incidental to the maintenance of a police force and the employment of police officers as said risks attach to the public consumers of the services provided by the New York City Police Department.

17. This action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving intentional actions, as well as the defendant, and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.

18. Plaintiff has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

STATEMENT OF FACTS

19. On April 7, 2018, at approximately 3:00 p.m., plaintiff was lawfully present in the vicinity of White Plains Road and East 227th Street, Bronx, New York, when the defendant police officers unlawfully stopped, questioned, frisked, searched, and falsely arrested plaintiff without reasonable suspicion probable cause or legal justification.

20. At no time relevant herein did plaintiff commit a crime or violate the law in any way, nor did the police officer have an objective reason to accuse plaintiff committing a crime or violating the law in any way.

21. At no point did defendants recover any drugs, weapons, or other illegal contraband from plaintiff in plaintiff's possession, custody or control.

22. Nevertheless, plaintiff was unlawfully arrested and unlawfully handcuffed by the defendant officers without legal justification or probable cause.

23. The defendant police officers transported plaintiff to the 48th Precinct against his will, where plaintiff was unlawfully photographed, fingerprinted and detained in a holding cell.

24. After many hours in unlawful custody, plaintiff was unlawfully transported to Bronx Central Booking and placed in a holding cell.

25. The defendant police officers maliciously initiated the prosecution against plaintiff by providing the DA's Office with false, misleading, and incomplete information regarding the facts that formed the officers' basis for arresting plaintiff.

26. Further, the defendant police officers signed and executed a criminal court complaint that contained false, misleading and incomplete information and/or evidence under oath and under the risk of a penalty of perjury.

27. The defendant police officers provided the District Attorney's Office with the false, misleading and/or incomplete information that plaintiff committed a crime.

28. On April 8, 2018, plaintiff was arraigned in Bronx County Criminal Court, charged with crimes that the defendant officers had no basis to alleged that he committed and was plaintiff was released on his own recognizance.

29. Plaintiff was unlawfully charged Possession of Marijuana.

30. Thereafter, plaintiff was forced to appear in Court on approximately 2 occasions before all charges were dismissed on July 16, 2018.

31. Plaintiff had to retain a criminal attorney in the amount of \$1,000 to represent him during the criminal proceedings.

32. Some of the police officer defendants observed the violation of plaintiff's rights under the Constitution of the United States and New York State Law and did nothing to prevent their fellow officers from unjustifiably searching, seizing, falsely arresting and imprisoning, maliciously prosecuting, and denying plaintiff the right to due process and a fair trial

33. The unlawful, search, seizure, false arrest and imprisonment, malicious prosecution, and denial of plaintiff's right to a fair trial by the individually named defendants caused plaintiff to sustain physical, psychological and emotional trauma.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Plaintiff's Fourth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights

34. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 33 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

35. The individually named police officer defendants while acting in concert and within the scope of their authority, caused plaintiff to be seized, unlawfully searched, falsely arrested, and falsely imprisoned, and maliciously prosecuted without reasonable suspicion and/or probable cause, in violation of plaintiff's right to be free of an unreasonable seizure under the Fourth Amendment of the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

36. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional, psychological and economic injuries.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION

False Arrest and False Imprisonment

37. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 36 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

38. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute false arrest and false imprisonment under the laws of the State of New York. Defendants intended to confine plaintiff and, in fact, confined plaintiff, and plaintiff was conscious of the confinement. In addition, plaintiff did not consent to the confinement and the confinement was not otherwise privileged.

39. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York and the United States Constitution.

40. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

41. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

42. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, economic, emotional and psychological injuries.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION

Unlawful Stop, Question, and Frisk

43. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 42 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

44. The illegal approach, pursuit, stop, questioning and frisk employed by defendants herein terminated plaintiff's freedom of movement through means intentionally applied.

45. The conduct of defendants in stopping, frisking, and searching plaintiff was performed under color of law and without any reasonable suspicion of criminality or other constitutionally required grounds.

46. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

47. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

48. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

49. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, economic, emotional and psychological injuries.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Unlawful Search

50. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 49 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

51. The illegal approach, pursuit, stop and search employed by defendants herein terminated plaintiff's freedom of movement through means intentionally applied.

52. Defendants lacked probable cause to search plaintiff.

53. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

54. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

55. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

56. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Plaintiff's Fifth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights

Denial of Right to Fair Trial/Due Process

57. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 56 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein

58. Defendants, individually and collectively, manufactured and/or withheld false evidence and forwarded this false evidence to prosecutors in the Bronx County District Attorney's Office.

59. Defendants filled out false and misleading police reports and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Bronx County District Attorney's Office.

60. Defendants signed false and misleading criminal court affidavits and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Bronx County District Attorney's Office.

61. In withholding/creating false evidence against plaintiff Cadeem Clarke, and in providing/withholding information with respect thereto, defendants violated plaintiff's constitutional right to due process and fair trial under the New York State Constitution and under the Due Process Clause of the Fifth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States and to be free to deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the United States Constitution.

62. As a result of the foregoing, plaintiff Cadeem Clarke, sustained, inter alia, loss of the right to due process and a fair trial, loss of liberty, emotional distress, embarrassment and humiliation, lost earnings and deprivation of his constitutional rights.

63. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

64. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

65. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Malicious Prosecution

66. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 65 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

67. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute malicious prosecution under the laws of the State of New York and New York State common law.

68. Defendants commenced and continued a criminal proceeding against plaintiff.

69. There was actual malice and an absence of probable cause for the criminal proceeding against plaintiff and for each of the charges for which they were prosecuted.

70. The prosecution and criminal proceedings terminated in plaintiff's favor on the aforementioned dates.

71. Plaintiff was subjected to a post-arraignment deprivation of liberty sufficient to implicate plaintiff's Fourth Amendment rights.

72. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York and the United States Constitution.

73. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

74. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Failure to Intervene

75. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 74 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

76. The defendants that did not physically touch plaintiff, but were present when other officers violated plaintiff's Constitutional Rights had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.

77. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein.

78. As a result of the foregoing, plaintiff's liberty was restricted for an extended period of time, he was put in fear of his safety, and he was humiliated and subject to other physical constraints.

79. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

80. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

81. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

82. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

JURY DEMAND

83. Plaintiff hereby demands trial by jury of all issues properly triable thereby.

PRAAYER FOR RELIEF

WHEREFORE, plaintiff Cadeem Clarke demands judgment against the defendants on each cause of action in amounts to be determined upon the trial of this action which exceeds the jurisdiction of lower courts, inclusive of punitive damages and attorneys' fees inclusive of costs and disbursements of this action, interest and such other relief as is appropriate under the law. That the plaintiff recover the cost of the suit herein, including reasonable attorney's fees pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988.

Dated: New York, New York
December 28, 2020

By: /s/
STUART E. JACOBS
JACOBS & HAZAN, LLP
Attorneys for Plaintiff
30 Vesey Street, 4th Floor
New York, NY 10007
(212) 577-2690

TO: DETECTIVE JOHN LINDSEY, Shield No. 4343, Narcotics Borough Bronx, One Police Plaza, Room 110-c, New York, NY 10038
UNDERCOVER POLICE OFFICER, Shield No. 352, Narcotics Borough Bronx, One Police Plaza, Room 110-c, New York, NY 10038
POLICE OFFICER LUIS MALDONADO, Shield No. 00836, Narcotics Borough Bronx, One Police Plaza, Room 110-c, New York, NY 10038
SERGEANT CECILIA LUCKIE, Narcotics Borough Bronx, One Police Plaza, Room 110-c, New York, NY 10038

ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION

STUART E. JACOBS, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the Courts of the State of New York, affirms the following to be true under the penalties of perjury:

I am a partner of the law firm of **JACOBS & HAZAN, LLP**, I have read the annexed **VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters therein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters I believe them to be true. My belief, as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon facts, records, and other pertinent information contained in my files. The reason this verification is made by me and not Plaintiff is because plaintiff does not reside in the county wherein I maintain my office.

DATED: New York, New York
December 28, 2020

/s/
STUART E. JACOBS